

- 55** Between 1954 and 1971 a mine in Northern Australia was releasing excess copper into the nearby Finnis River. Copper ions are poisonous and most of the types of fish living in the river died. The river still remains polluted with copper, but scientists have discovered one type of rainbow fish that is able to survive and live in the river.

A student wrote the following statements in order to explain this information.

- 1** One type of rainbow fish did not die out in the river because this type was able to adapt to the changing environment.
- 2** None of the other types of fish showed any type of genetic variation.
- 3** The presence of copper ions acted as a selective pressure.

Which of the student's statements could be correct?

- A** 1 only
- B** 1 and 2 only
- C** 1 and 3 only
- D** 2 and 3 only
- E** 1, 2 and 3